Captain Kulwant Singh had been in Jorhat when the battalion was being inducted. He had made his way back to the battalion and had hardly landed in Walong when he was sent to Mithun to join Bravo Company. He had reached the company position on 15 November when the Chinese began firing at the bunkers with 55 mm recoilless guns. Despite the damage, the Sikhs stood firm. At night, the Chinese had managed to send jitter parties into the gap between Mithun and Maha Plateau, keeping the men on their toes. At first light, the Chinese put in an attack but were easily beaten back. In the immediate lull, the company commander dispatched the section to Maha Plateau. The second attack came at around 7.30 a.m., this time from all sides.

Around midday, the orders to withdraw were received and Harbans Singh decided to pull out from Mithun. As Bravo Company moved out, heading down the track that linked up with the western track between Kibithu and Walong, Harbans asked Kulwant Singh to bring up the rearguard. Along with his orderly and an artillery officer, Captain G. P. Bharnagar, who was still trying to direct supporting fire, Kulwant Singh's little group huddled together behind a rock. Fortunately for them, the Chinese did not move immediately to occupy Mithun, instead pulling back to regroup themselves.

'There were still some of the Gorkhas from Lachhman Ridge trying to escape down the track that went through my position,' recalls Kulwant, 'and I was determined to pull out only after the last man had left. The Chinese were shooting at us, so I told Bharnagar that we should wait for an hour or so, and pull out once it got dark. He seemed to nod in agreement, but then he just slumped, shot through the head. In disbelief I turned towards my orderly, who had pulled out the pin from a grenade. He just handed it to me and toppled over backwards, falling off the cliff without making a sound. He was just looking at me, his eyes transfixed. I suppose he had died instantly. I started to sprint and underhand threw the grenade that was live. The blast lifted me off my feet and sent me tumbling and crashing down into the vegetation, coming to a halt on the track below.' Kulwant, badly wounded and barely alive, was found below the track by the Chinese the next day.

16 NOVEMBER: THE LADDERS AND THE EAST BANK